



My second fake text

The morning sunlight filtered through the blinds of Apartment 4B at 1827 Maple Grove Avenue, Denver, CO 80206, as Arjun Mehta reached over to silence his alarm. His phone lit up briefly, displaying a notification from his bank—First Continental Credit Union—reminding him that his account ending in 4821 had a scheduled payment due. He made a mental note to check it later, then swung his legs off the bed.

Arjun, who had moved to Denver just six months ago, still found himself adjusting to the altitude and pace of life. Originally from Edison, New Jersey, he often joked that he had traded crowded train rides for mountain views. His driver's license, issued in New Jersey with the number MHTA-AJ-9043, still sat in his wallet, though he knew he'd need to update it soon.

His phone buzzed again—this time a text from his coworker, Emily Carter.

"Hey Arjun, don't forget the 10 AM call with the client. Also, can you send me your updated contact info? HR needs it."

Arjun sighed, got up, and headed to the kitchen. While the coffee brewed, he opened his laptop and typed out a quick message:

"Sure, here you go:
Arjun Mehta
1827 Maple Grove Ave, Apt 4B
Denver, CO 80206
Phone: (303) 555-7812
Email: arjun.mehta92@gmail.com"

He paused, then added his employee ID: EMP-88374, knowing HR would ask for it anyway.

Across town, at 945 South Lincoln Street, lived Maria Gonzalez, a freelance graphic designer. She was reviewing a contract she had just received from a new client, BluePeak Marketing LLC. The contract listed her as:

Maria Elena Gonzalez
SSN: 482-17-9304
DOB: 07/14/1990
Address: 945 S Lincoln St, Denver, CO 80209

REVENUE BAR CHARTS

While Power Slides revenue grew 10x between 2012 and 2015, its costs kept pace. Investors were underfunded, sending Power Slides stock price up 7x.



She hesitated before sending it back signed. She always felt uneasy including her Social Security number, even though it was standard for tax purposes. She made a note to ask her accountant, David Rosen (david.rosen@finadvisors.com, (720) 555-9981), whether she could use her EIN instead for future contracts.

Para1

Meanwhile, in a quiet suburb just outside the city, Thomas Nguyen was dropping his daughter off at school. His car, a silver 2018 Honda Accord with license plate CO-7XJ921, idled briefly as he checked his email.

One message stood out:

“Subject: Urgent – Verify Your Identity

Dear Thomas Nguyen,

We noticed unusual activity on your account ending in 6632. Please confirm your identity using the following details...”

Thomas frowned. He had learned to be cautious. The email asked him to verify his full name, date of birth (03/22/1985), and the last four digits of his SSN (7742). It looked convincing, but something felt off. He decided to call his bank directly instead of clicking the link.

Back at the office, Emily Carter was organizing employee records. Her spreadsheet contained dozens of entries, each with names, phone numbers, and addresses. One row read:

Name: Jonathan Blake
Email: jon.blake88@yahoo.com
Phone: (970) 555-2234
Address: 221B Walnut Creek Rd, Boulder, CO 80302
DOB: 11/08/1988

She double-checked the data against the HR system, making sure everything was accurate. Data integrity was critical—especially since the company had recently experienced a minor security incident involving leaked employee emails.

At noon, Arjun met his friend Kevin Patel for lunch at a small café. Kevin, who worked in cybersecurity, had plenty to say about data privacy.

“You’d be surprised how often people share sensitive info without thinking,” Kevin said. “Last week, I saw someone post their full address and phone number on a public forum.”

Arjun laughed. “Well, I just sent all my details to HR this morning.”

Kevin raised an eyebrow. “That’s different—internal systems are supposed to be secure. But still, you should be careful. Even something like your email—arjun.mehta92@gmail.com—can be used in phishing attacks.”

Later that afternoon, Maria received a call from an unfamiliar number: (415) 555-6721.

“Hello, is this Maria Gonzalez?” the caller asked.

“Yes, speaking.”

“This is Jason Lee from West Coast Financial Services. We’re calling to confirm your application for a business credit line.”

Maria frowned. “I didn’t apply for anything.”

The caller hesitated, then hung up.

Concerned, Maria immediately checked her credit report. Sure enough, there was an inquiry she didn’t recognize. She called the credit bureau and provided her details:

Full Name: Maria Elena Gonzalez
SSN: 482-17-9304
Address: 945 S Lincoln St, Denver, CO 80209

The representative assured her they would investigate and suggested placing a fraud alert on her account.

Across the city, Thomas Nguyen had just finished speaking with his bank. They confirmed that the earlier email was indeed a phishing attempt.

Para2

“We recommend you monitor your account and avoid sharing personal details over email,” the representative said.

Thomas nodded, even though they couldn’t see him. He thought about how easily someone could misuse information like his phone number—(303) 555-1147—or his email, thomas.nguyen85@outlook.com.

That evening, Emily Carter updated the company’s internal policy document. It included guidelines like:

- Never share SSNs via email
- Use employee IDs instead of full personal details when possible
- Mask sensitive data (e.g., show only last 4 digits of SSN: 233-11-7742)
- Encrypt files containing PII

She sent the document to all employees, including Arjun, Kevin, and Jonathan Blake.

Arjun read through it carefully. It made him think about how much of his own information was scattered across systems—his address, phone number, even his date of birth (09/12/1992).

He opened a note on his phone and began listing accounts he needed to secure:

- Gmail: arjun.mehta92@gmail.com
- Bank: First Continental CU (Acct: ****4821)
- Work ID: EMP-88374
- Phone: (303) 555-7812

Meanwhile, Maria received an update from the credit bureau. The fraudulent inquiry had been flagged, and no new accounts had been opened in her name.

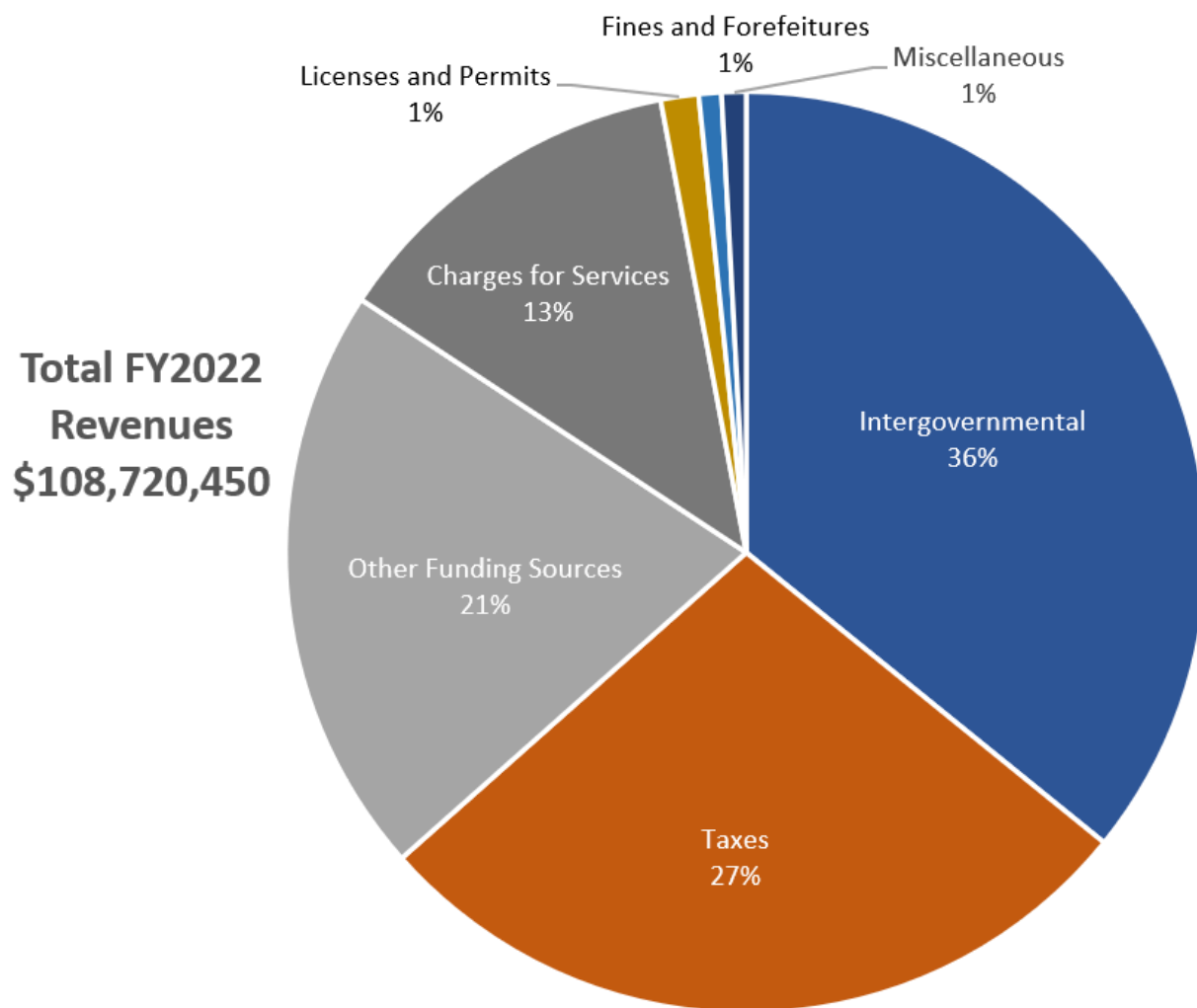
Relieved, she decided to take extra precautions. She updated her passwords, enabled two-factor authentication, and even considered using a virtual address for business registrations instead of her home at 945 S Lincoln St.

As night fell, the city lights flickered on. Each of these individuals—Arjun, Maria, Thomas, Emily—carried with them a web of personal data: names, numbers, addresses, identifiers.

Data that, in the right hands, enabled daily life.

And in the wrong hands, could unravel it.

The next morning, Arjun decided to take Kevin’s advice more seriously. Before heading to work, he logged into his online banking portal. The login screen prompted him for his username—amehta92—and a one-time passcode sent to his registered number, (303) 555-7812. After entering the code, he navigated to his profile settings and noticed that his recovery email was still set to an old address: arjun.m92@outlook.com.



“That needs to be updated,” he muttered.

He replaced it with his current email, arjun.mehta92@gmail.com, and added an extra layer of security by enabling biometric authentication. The system confirmed the update and displayed a reference number: SEC-UPD-20260327-1192.

At the office, Emily Carter was already deep into a compliance audit. The company had recently onboarded a new vendor, Apex Data Solutions Inc., located at 1200 Market Street, Suite 500, San Francisco, CA 94103. As part of the onboarding process, they had submitted a list of authorized contacts:

Primary Contact: Daniel Brooks
Email: daniel.brooks@apexdata.com
Phone: (415) 555-8823
Employee ID: AD-77421

Secondary Contact: Priya Shah
Email: priya.shah@apexdata.com
Phone: (415) 555-7745

Emily cross-referenced these details with the vendor agreement and ensured that all sensitive fields were encrypted in their internal system. She also verified that no full SSNs were stored—only masked versions like XXX-XX-5521 already.

Meanwhile, Maria Gonzalez had scheduled a meeting with her accountant, David Rosen, at his office located at 1600 Broadway, Suite 2100, Denver, CO 80202. As she entered, she checked in at the front desk, providing her name and phone number: (720) 555-4412.

David greeted her warmly. “Maria, good to see you. I reviewed your concerns about using your SSN—482-17-9304—for contracts. You’re right to be cautious.”

He handed her a document outlining the steps to apply for an EIN:

Applicant Name: Maria Elena Gonzalez
Business Name: MG Creative Studio
Business Address: 945 S Lincoln St, Denver, CO 80209
Contact Email: maria.gonzalez.design@gmail.com

“With an EIN, you can avoid sharing your SSN with clients,” David explained. “It’s much safer.”

Maria nodded. “Let’s do it.”

Across town, Thomas Nguyen was attending a parent-teacher conference at Ridgeview Elementary School, located at 7850 East Iliff Avenue, Denver, CO 80231. He signed in at the front desk:

Name: Thomas Nguyen
Child: Lily Nguyen
Contact Number: (303) 555-1147
Email: thomas.nguyen85@outlook.com

The teacher, Mrs. Henderson, pulled up Lily's records. "Everything looks great academically," she said. "We just need to update your emergency contact information."

Para3

Thomas provided an additional contact:

Emergency Contact: Linh Nguyen (Spouse)
Phone: (303) 555-6678
Relationship: Mother

Later that afternoon, Emily received an alert from the IT security system. It flagged an unusual data export from an internal database. The export included fields like:

- Full Name
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Home Address
- Employee ID

The user responsible was listed as: Jonathan Blake (Employee ID: EMP-99213, Email: jon.blake88@yahoo.com).

Emily immediately contacted IT.

"Can you verify if this export was authorized?" she asked.

The IT analyst, Marcus Lee (marcus.lee@company.com, (303) 555-7789), responded, "We're checking now. The file was downloaded to a local machine with IP address 192.168.1.45."

Emily felt a knot in her stomach. If that data included unmasked PII, it could be a serious issue.

Meanwhile, Arjun was working on a client project involving customer data anonymization. The dataset included entries like:

Customer Name: Rebecca Turner
Email: rebecca.turner1975@gmail.com
Phone: (720) 555-3321
Address: 2210 Cherry Creek Dr N, Denver, CO 80209

SSN: 593-22-1184

His task was to ensure that all sensitive fields were masked before the data could be used for analytics. He wrote a note to himself:

“Mask SSN → XXX-XX-1184 already

Mask Phone → (720) XXX-3321

Mask Email → r****@[gmail.com](mailto:r****@gmail.com)” already

He planned to use Databricks’ `ai_query()` function for this, crafting a prompt that would allow flexible masking rules.

Back at David Rosen’s office, Maria completed her EIN application. The system generated a confirmation:

EIN: 84-7291536

Application ID: EIN-APP-20260327-5529

David printed a copy and handed it to her. “Keep this secure. Don’t share it unless necessary.”

Maria carefully placed it in a folder labeled “Tax Documents.”

That evening, Thomas Nguyen received a call from his insurance provider, Rocky Mountain Insurance Group.

“Hello, Mr. Nguyen. We’re updating your policy. Can you confirm your address: 3120 South Yosemite Street, Aurora, CO 80014?”

“Yes, that’s correct.”

“And your date of birth, 03/22/1985?”

Thomas hesitated briefly, then confirmed. He trusted the provider, but he still made a mental note to verify the call by checking the official number listed on their website: (800) 555-9900.

At the same time, Emily Carter finalized her audit report. It included a summary of findings:

- 3 instances of unmasked phone numbers
- 1 unauthorized data export (under investigation)
- 0 full SSNs stored in plaintext

She submitted the report under document ID: AUD-REP-2026-03-27-EC.

Before logging off, she sent a reminder to all employees:

“Please ensure that any files containing PII (e.g., names, addresses, SSNs, phone numbers) are encrypted and access-controlled. If you need help, contact IT at support@company.com or (303) 555-9001.”

Arjun read the message and nodded. He had already started implementing masking in his workflow.

Maria, now feeling more secure with her new EIN, updated her client templates to remove her SSN. She replaced it with:

Tax ID (EIN): 84-7291536

Thomas, after putting Lily to bed, reviewed his accounts one last time. He changed his email password and enabled alerts for any login attempts.

As the day came to a close, each of them had taken small but meaningful steps to protect their personal information.

Yet, the digital world around them continued to grow—filled with data points, identifiers, and records:

Names tied to emails.

Addresses linked to phone numbers.

Numbers that defined identities.

And somewhere, in systems both secure and vulnerable, all of it continued to exist—waiting to be protected, or exposed.